

BALAAJEE V.R.

Senior UI/UX Design Manager

- Immediate Availability
- Open to India / Global Relocation

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Chennai / Bengaluru, India
LinkedIn Profile ↗

18+ Years	50+	100%	25+	8+	10M+
in Product Design	Designers Mentored	Team Retention	Products Shipped	Industry Domains	Users Impacted

Senior UI/UX Design Manager
Sep 2024 – Jan 2026

IBM India Software Labs

Agentic AI UX | Human-in-the-Loop | Design System Governance | Org Restructuring

- Spearheaded the UX transformation of enterprise B2B platforms by integrating generative AI and agentic workflows (IBM watsonx), cutting complex task completion from **14.2 hours to 3.6 hours**.
- Restructured and scaled a multidisciplinary organization of **14+ UI/UX designers** into an agile **UX-as-a-Service model**, establishing career ladders, advancing 2 designers into lead tracks, and maintaining **100% retention**.
- Directed the UX architecture for AI confidence thresholds and automated security remediation workflows, cutting threat triage from **4.1 hours to 43 minutes** across 140,000+ enterprise tasks.
- Embedded AI tools into day-to-day DesignOps — upskilling the team, leading cross-functional AI-UX workshops, and driving **IBM Carbon Design System** adoption across US and European squads to accelerate design-to-dev handoff.

UI/UX Product Design Manager
Jul 2021 – Aug 2024

Zebra Technologies

Enterprise Mobility | Team Scaling | Performance Management | PI Planning

- Directed UX strategy and end-to-end execution across B2B mobile devices, enterprise cloud consoles, and industrial scanner telemetry platforms serving **38,000+ rugged Android endpoints**.
- Built and scaled high-performing UX teams from the ground up — leading hiring, mentoring, performance & exit management, and quarterly **Program Increment (PI) planning**.
- Designed high-contrast, gloved-touch ergonomic workflows for warehouse and retail operators, dropping Bluetooth scanner pairing failures by **84%** and reducing Tier-1 support tickets by **33%**.

UI/UX Senior Specialist
Oct 2020 – Jul 2021

ZF Wabco

Cockpit UX | Driver Safety | Fleet Telematics | Usability Testing

- Spearheaded UX/UI design for next-generation commercial vehicle digital cockpit displays and fleet management platforms in collaboration with German engineering headquarters.
- Reduced average driver glance duration from **2.8 seconds to 0.94 seconds** (well below the 1.2s safety ceiling) through 3-tier hierarchical alert triage and high-contrast visual hierarchy.
- Led contextual driver research and simulator usability testing, reducing critical route navigation errors by **18%** across 80,000+ commercial transport vehicles.

UI/UX Designer
Jul 2019 – Sep 2020

Ericsson Global

CPQ Platform | Data Workflows | UX Workshops | Information Architecture

- Replaced a fragmented 14-tab legacy Excel pricing process with a unified, keyboard-first enterprise CPQ deal platform for multi-million-dollar 5G telecom network bids.
- Slashed enterprise quote turnaround time from **6 days to 42 minutes** while eliminating manual pricing formula errors and achieving **94% organic adoption** within 30 days.
- Conducted cross-border UX discovery workshops with Swedish product stakeholders to establish scalable UI component libraries and high-density data visualization standards.

Lead UI/UX Designer
Sep 2017 – Jul 2019

NP Compete Technologies

Product Design | Team Leadership | UX Roadmaps | Pattern Libraries

- Directed end-to-end product design cycles, managing sprint planning, resource allocation, and a team of UI/UX designers to ensure timely delivery of high-fidelity interactive prototypes.
- Led customer requirement gathering sessions, acting as the primary UX liaison to translate complex business requirements into actionable product design roadmaps.
- Facilitated stakeholder UX workshops and user research to establish foundational style guides, reusable UI patterns, and intuitive information architecture.

EARLIER EXPERIENCE

Freelance UI/UX Designer
May 2015 – Aug 2017

Designed end-to-end mobile applications, responsive web platforms, interactive wireframes, and usability flows for international startup and SMB clients.

Creative Head
May 2010 – Apr 2015

Titi Technologies

Led a multidisciplinary creative team across digital product UI, brand identity systems, and interactive mobile application experiences from concept to App Store launch.

Senior Software Engineer
Jan 2006 – Apr 2010

Infosys Technologies

Developed, customized, and tested enterprise banking software modules for Finacle Universal Banking, building a strong technical foundation in front-end engineering and enterprise workflows.



PEOPLE & ORG MANAGEMENT

Hiring & Scaling: End-to-end interview loops, portfolio evaluations & onboarding.
Performance & Growth: Career ladders, promotions, performance turnaround & 1:1 coaching.
DesignOps & Delivery: UX-as-a-Service capacity planning, PI planning & design critiques.
Global Collaboration: Direct alignment across US, German, Swedish & Indian hubs.

EXPERTISE

Strategy: Product Vision, Service Blueprints, Multi-Brand Design Systems.
Research: Contextual Inquiry, Simulator & Lab Usability Testing, Journey Mapping, Heuristic Audits.
Execution: Information Architecture, Complex B2B Workflows, Engineering Handoff.

INDUSTRY DOMAINS

- Enterprise AI & SaaS
- Industrial IoT & Mobility
- Automotive & Telematics
- 5G Telecom & CPQ
- Healthcare Systems
- Core Banking & FinTech

TOOLS & GOVERNANCE

AI Tools: Microsoft Copilot, ChatGPT Enterprise, IBM watsonx, Google Stitch, NotebookLM, Google AI Studio, Gemini.
Design: Figma, Miro, Mural, Adobe Creative Cloud.
Operations: Jira, Monday.com, Confluence, Dual-Track Agile.
Research: UserTesting, Hotjar, Google Analytics.
Governance: Enterprise Accessibility, Design System Governance, AI Human-Oversight, Data Privacy.

AWARDS

Ericsson: Spot Award for UX innovation culture & 1st Place in Global Hack-fest Contest.
Infosys: 3rd Place Winner & Best Project Nominee, Telstra Annual Excellence Awards.
Samsung: Sponsored for 10-Year US Business Visa to lead global healthcare UX research.
Consumer Impact: Designed *"Greedy Jump"* iOS game achieving 80,000+ organic downloads.
UX Challenges: 1st Place Winner in MockingBOT & UP Labs Global Design Contests.

EDUCATION

B.E. Information Technology
MS University